Skill Vector — Shortcuts & Guide

Generated 2026-10-18 from the app's own command table · macOS and Windows / Linux

WHAT SKILL VECTOR IS

A vector illustration and design studio for desktop (Tauri) and the browser. Everything runs locally on your machine: Bézier pen and anchor editing, multiple artboards, Pathfinder booleans (Unite, Minus Front, Intersect, Exclude), compound paths and Outline Stroke, with SVG, PDF and PSD export. Unsaved work is autosaved for crash recovery.

Workflow essentials

- **Open** images with `⌘O`, drag-and-drop, or paste (`⌘V`). Shift-drop places files as layers.
- **Adjust** — every adjustment goes on its own maskable adjustment layer. Presets: Pop, Teal & Orange, Golden Hour, Moody B&W, Clean Portrait, Faded Film, Crisp Landscape, Noir, Cool Matte, High Key, Neon Night, Antique.
- **Auto Enhance** analyses the photo and builds a tuned adjustment layer you can keep editing.
- **Remove objects** — paint over them with the Spot Healing Brush, or select and press `⇧⌫`.
- **Masks** — paint black to hide, white to reveal; `Q` toggles mask editing.
- **Run anything** from the command palette, `⌘K`.

Filters (live preview, respect selections)

Blur: Gaussian Blur, Motion Blur
Sharpen: Unsharp Mask, High Pass
Noise: Add Noise, Reduce Noise
Stylize: Pixelate, Emboss, Find Edges
Creative: Dreamy Glow (Orton), Chromatic Aberration, Halftone Dots

Adjustment panel

Light, Color, Presence & Effects, Curves, Levels, Color Mixer (HSL), Color Grading.

Pointer precision: paint lands exactly under the pointer. Brush **Smoothing** (options bar) adds a stabilizer: paint follows the pointer on a string of that length, drawn on screen, and every stroke still ends exactly where you release. Pen pressure controls size (and optionally opacity). Zoom with `⌘+` / `⌘−`, pinch, or ⌘-scroll; the point under the cursor stays put. `⌘0` fits, `⌘1` is 100%, hold `Space` to pan with any tool. Moving a layer snaps its edges and centre to the canvas and to other layers, with guides on screen; hold ⌘ to move freely. On Windows / Linux use Ctrl where macOS uses ⌘.

TOOLS

- **Master Selection Tool** (⇧V) — Master Smart Selection: Reads and copies text from images, selects objects, and extracts content.
- **Selection Tool** (V) — Selects, moves, rotates and transforms entire objects and groups.
- **Direct Selection Tool** (A) — Selects individual anchor points and curve handles.
- **Group Selection Tool** (A) — Selects an object within a group; click again to select its parent group.
- **Magic Wand Tool** (Y) — Selects objects sharing similar fill color, stroke weight, or appearance.
- **Lasso Tool** (Q) — Draws a freehand selection loop to select anchor points.
- **Pen Tool** (P) — Draws precise Bézier vector paths with corner and curve points.
- **Add Anchor Point Tool** (+) — Adds new anchor points onto an existing vector path.
- **Delete Anchor Point Tool** (-) — Deletes anchor points from a path without breaking continuity.
- **Anchor Point Tool** (⇧C) — Converts smooth curves to sharp corners or pulls new tangent handles.
- **Curvature Tool** (⇧P) — Creates smooth harmonic curves intuitively without tangent handles.
- **Line Segment Tool** (\) — Draws individual straight line vector segments.
- **Arc Tool** (\) — Draws open or closed curved arc segments.
- **Spiral Tool** (\) — Draws logarithmic or Archimedean spiral curves.
- **Rectangular Grid Tool** (\) — Draws Cartesian rectangular coordinate grids.
- **Polar Grid Tool** (\) — Draws concentric polar circular coordinate grids.
- **Shape Tool** (M) — Draws vector geometric shapes.
- **Rectangle Tool** (M) — Draws vector rectangles and squares (Shift).
- **Rounded Rectangle Tool** (M) — Draws rectangles with adjustable live corner radii.
- **Ellipse Tool** (L) — Draws vector ellipses and circles (Shift).
- **Polygon Tool** (M) — Draws regular multi-sided polygons.
- **Star Tool** (M) — Draws multi-pointed stars with inner and outer radii.
- **Flare Tool** (M) — Creates lens flare vector effects with rings and rays.
- **Type Tool** (T) — Creates horizontal point type or area text blocks.
- **Area Type Tool** (T) — Flows text strictly within any closed vector path.
- **Type on a Path Tool** (T) — Flows text dynamically along the contour of any vector path.
- **Vertical Type Tool** (T) — Creates vertical top-to-bottom Asian lettering.
- **Vertical Area Type Tool** (T) — Flows vertical typography inside a vector shape.
- **Vertical Type on a Path Tool** (T) — Flows vertical typography along a path curve.
- **Touch Type Tool** (⇧T) — Directly moves, scales, and rotates single characters in live text.
- **Paintbrush Tool** (B) — Draws freehand vector paths with calligraphic stroke styles.
- **Blob Brush Tool** (⇧B) — Paints closed filled paths that automatically merge with matching fills.
- **Pencil Tool** (N) — Draws freehand vector paths that automatically fit into smooth Béziers.
- **Smooth Tool** (N) — Drags over rough vector paths to reduce anchors and smooth curves.
- **Path Eraser Tool** (N) — Erases path segments along the trajectory of your drag.
- **Join Tool** (N) — Scribbles over intersecting or gap endpoints to join paths.
- **Shaper Tool** (⇧N) — Recognizes rough hand-drawn gestures into clean geometric vector shapes.
- **Rotate Tool** (R) — Rotates vector artwork around a designated origin point.
- **Reflect Tool** (O) — Flips and mirrors vector artwork across an axis.
- **Scale Tool** (S) — Resizes objects proportionally or non-uniformly from a center anchor.
- **Shear Tool** (S) — Slants and skews vector paths along an axis.
- **Reshape Tool** (S) — Stretches curve segments without breaking tangent continuity.
- **Free Transform Tool** (E) — Transforms bounds with interactive perspective and free distort.
- **Puppet Warp Tool** (E) — Places pins on vector artwork to organically bend and deform.
- **Width Tool** (⇧W) — Interactively expands or contracts stroke profile widths along paths.
- **Warp Tool** (⇧R) — Liquifies and pushes vector paths in the direction of cursor drag.
- **Twirl Tool** (⇧R) — Swirls vector vertices in a vortex around the cursor.
- **Pucker Tool** (⇧R) — Pinches path vertices inward toward the cursor.
- **Bloat Tool** (⇧R) — Deflates path vertices outward away from the cursor.
- **Scallop Tool** (⇧R) — Carves curved scallop teeth along vector borders.
- **Crystallize Tool** (⇧R) — Extrudes sharp starburst spikes outward from vector edges.
- **Wrinkle Tool** (⇧R) — Adds random organic ripples and noise to vector edges.
- **Shape Builder Tool** (⇧M) — Merges overlapping shape fragments (drag) or subtracts them (⌥-drag).
- **Eraser Tool** (⇧E) — Vector eraser that slices through paths and divides filled shapes.
- **Scissors Tool** (C) — Cuts paths at clicked anchor points or segment locations.
- **Knife Tool** (C) — Freehand slices across vector shapes to divide them into pieces.
- **Mesh Tool** (U) — Creates gradient mesh grids for photorealistic vector shading.
- **Gradient Tool** (G) — Edits vector linear and radial gradients directly on the canvas.
- **Eyedropper Tool** (I) — Samples and transfers fill, stroke, typography, and styling attributes.
- **Measure Tool** (I) — Measures distances, angles, and coordinates on the canvas.
- **Blend Tool** (W) — Generates intermediate vector shape and color morph steps.
- **Image Trace Tool** (⇧I) — Click a picture to turn it into vector paths (Auto picks the settings); drag to trace one part; ⌥-click to pick exact trace colours.
- **Live Paint Bucket** (K) — Fills enclosed facet regions in complex line art.
- **Live Paint Selection Tool** (⇧L) — Selects individual faces and edges of Live Paint groups.
- **Symbol Sprayer Tool** (⇧S) — Sprays instances of vector symbols onto the canvas.
- **Symbol Shifter Tool** (⇧S) — Moves sprayed symbol instances around.
- **Symbol Scruncher Tool** (⇧S) — Pulls symbol instances closer together or pushes them apart.
- **Symbol Sizer Tool** (⇧S) — Dynamically scales symbol instances.
- **Symbol Spinner Tool** (⇧S) — Rotates symbol instances dynamically.
- **Symbol Stainer Tool** (⇧S) — Tints symbol instances with current foreground color.
- **Symbol Screener Tool** (⇧S) — Adjusts opacity of symbol instances.
- **Symbol Styler Tool** (⇧S) — Applies active graphic styles to symbol instances.
- **Column Graph Tool** (J) — Generates vertical column bar charts from vector data.
- **Stacked Column Graph Tool** (J) — Generates stacked vertical column charts.
- **Bar Graph Tool** (J) — Generates horizontal bar charts.
- **Stacked Bar Graph Tool** (J) — Generates horizontal stacked bar charts.
- **Line Graph Tool** (J) — Generates vector line graphs.
- **Area Graph Tool** (J) — Generates vector area charts.
- **Scatter Graph Tool** (J) — Generates XY scatter plot charts.
- **Pie Graph Tool** (J) — Generates circular pie charts.
- **Radar Graph Tool** (J) — Generates spider/radar graphs.
- **Slice Tool** (⇧K) — Divides artwork into web export slices.
- **Slice Select Tool** (⇧K) — Selects and configures web export slices.
- **Artboard Tool** (⇧O) — Creates, resizes, duplicates and arranges multi-artboards.
- **Packaging Dieline Tool** (⇧D) — Generates and edits box dielines, crease nets, and cut contours.
- **Hand Tool** (H) — Pans the canvas view. Hold Space for quick pan.

- **Print Tiling Tool** (H) — Adjusts printable boundary page tiles.
- **Zoom Tool** (Z) — Click to zoom in, ⌥-click to zoom out (up to 64,000%).
- **Perspective Grid Tool** (⇧P) — Displays 1-point, 2-point, or 3-point perspective grid.
- **Perspective Selection Tool** (⇧V) — Transforms objects in perspective planes.
- **Rectangular Marquee** (M) — Rectangular selection.
- **Elliptical Marquee** (M) — Elliptical selection.
- **Polygonal Lasso** (L) — Polygon selection points.
- **Crop Tool** (C) — Crops canvas boundaries.
- **Clone Stamp** (S) — Clones pixel areas.
- **Spot Healing Brush** (J) — Retouching.
- **Smudge Tool** (R) — Smudges pixels.
- **Dodge Tool** (O) — Lightens pixels.
- **Burn Tool** (O) — Darkens pixels.
- **Sponge Tool** (O) — Saturates/desaturates.
- **Blur Tool** (R) — Softens details.
- **Sharpen Tool** (R) — Sharpens details.
- **Single Row Marquee** (M) — Row marquee.
- **Single Column Marquee** (M) — Column marquee.
- **Quick Selection** (W) — Quick selection.
- **Magic Eraser** (E) — Erases matching pixels.
- **Background Eraser** (E) — Erases background.
- **Color Replacement** (B) — Recolors pixels.
- **Red Eye Tool** (J) — Removes red eye.
- **History Brush** (Y) — Paints historical state.
- **Healing Brush** (J) — Blends texture.
- **Color Sampler** (I) — Pins color readouts.

KEYBOARD SHORTCUTS — MENUS

File menu

ACTION	MACOS	WINDOWS / LINUX
New	⌘N	Ctrl+N
New from Template	⌘⌥N	Ctrl+Alt+N
Open	⌘O	Ctrl+O
Place Image / Vector	⌘⇧P	Ctrl+Shift+P
Save Project (.illustratorscale)	⌘S	Ctrl+S
Export As	⌘⌥⇧W	Ctrl+Alt+Shift+W
Multi-Format Batch Export	⌘⇧E	Ctrl+Shift+E
Close Document	⌘W	Ctrl+W

Edit menu

ACTION	MACOS	WINDOWS / LINUX
Undo	⌘Z	Ctrl+Z
Redo	⌘⇧Z	Ctrl+Shift+Z
Cut	⌘X	Ctrl+X
Copy	⌘C	Ctrl+C
Copy Merged	⌘⇧C	Ctrl+Shift+C
Clear / Delete	⌫	Del
Fill with Foreground Color	⌥⌫	Alt+Del
Fill with Background Color	⌘⌫	Ctrl+Del
Content-Aware Fill (Remove Object)	⇧⌫	Shift+Del
Free Transform	⌘T	Ctrl+T
Preferences	⌘,	Ctrl+,

Object menu

ACTION	MACOS	WINDOWS / LINUX
Bring to Front	⌘⇧]	Ctrl+Shift+]
Bring Forward	⌘]	Ctrl+]
Send Backward	⌘[	Ctrl+[
Send to Back	⌘⇧[	Ctrl+Shift+[
Transform Again	⌘D	Ctrl+D
Transform Each	⌘⌥⇧D	Ctrl+Alt+Shift+D
Free Transform	⌘T	Ctrl+T
Group	⌘G	Ctrl+G
Ungroup	⌘⇧G	Ctrl+Shift+G
Lock Selection	⌘2	Ctrl+2
Unlock All	⌘⌥2	Ctrl+Alt+2
Hide Selection	⌘3	Ctrl+3
Show All	⌘⌥3	Ctrl+Alt+3
Join Path Endpoints	⌘J	Ctrl+J
Make Compound Path	⌘8	Ctrl+8
Release Compound Path	⌘⌥⇧8	Ctrl+Alt+Shift+8
Make / Release Clipping Mask	⌘7	Ctrl+7
Appearance & Styles	⌘⌥Y	Ctrl+Alt+Y

Type menu

ACTION	MACOS	WINDOWS / LINUX
Type Tool	T	T
Glyphs & Special Characters	⌘⌥G	Ctrl+Alt+G
Create Outlines (Vector Path)	⌘⇧O	Ctrl+Shift+O

Select menu

ACTION	MACOS	WINDOWS / LINUX
All	⌘A	Ctrl+A
Deselect	⌘D	Ctrl+D
Reselect	⌘⇧D	Ctrl+Shift+D
Inverse	⌘⇧I	Ctrl+Shift+I

Effect menu

ACTION	MACOS	WINDOWS / LINUX
Repeat Last Effect	⌘⌥F	Ctrl+Alt+F

View menu

ACTION	MACOS	WINDOWS / LINUX
Outline / Preview Mode	⌘Y	Ctrl+Y
Proof Colors (CMYK Print)	⌘⌥⇧Y	Ctrl+Alt+Shift+Y
Gamut Warning	⌘⇧Y	Ctrl+Shift+Y
Zoom In	⌘+	Ctrl++
Zoom Out	⌘–	Ctrl+–
Fit Artboard in Window	⌘0	Ctrl+0
Fit All in Window	⌘⌥0	Ctrl+Alt+0
Actual Size (100%)	⌘1	Ctrl+1
Rulers	⌘R	Ctrl+R
Grid	⌘'	Ctrl+'
Snap to Grid	⌘⌥'	Ctrl+Alt+'
Layout Grids	⌘;	Ctrl+;
Auto Grid	⌘⌥;	Ctrl+Alt+;
Smart Guides & Margins	⌘⇧'	Ctrl+Shift+'
Before / After Preview	\	\
Focus Mode (hide panels)	Tab	Tab

Window menu

ACTION	MACOS	WINDOWS / LINUX
Focus Mode (Hide Panels)	Tab	Tab
Command Palette	⌘K	Ctrl+K

Help menu

ACTION	MACOS	WINDOWS / LINUX
Keyboard Shortcuts	⌘/	Ctrl+/

KEYBOARD SHORTCUTS — TOOLS, BRUSH & POINTER

Tools

ACTION	MACOS	WINDOWS / LINUX
Master Selection Tool	⇧V	⇧V
Selection Tool	V	V
Direct Selection Tool	A	A
Group Selection Tool	⇧A	Shift+A
Magic Wand Tool	Y	Y
Lasso Tool	Q	Q
Pen Tool	P	P
Add Anchor Point Tool	+	+
Delete Anchor Point Tool	–	–
Anchor Point Tool	⇧C	⇧C
Curvature Tool	⇧P	⇧P
Line Segment Tool	\	\
Arc Tool	⇧\	Shift+\
Spiral Tool	⇧\	Shift+\
Rectangular Grid Tool	⇧\	Shift+\
Polar Grid Tool	⇧\	Shift+\
Shape Tool	M	M
Rectangle Tool	⇧M	Shift+M
Rounded Rectangle Tool	⇧M	Shift+M
Ellipse Tool	L	L
Polygon Tool	⇧M	Shift+M
Star Tool	⇧M	Shift+M
Flare Tool	⇧M	Shift+M
Type Tool	T	T
Area Type Tool	⇧T	Shift+T
Type on a Path Tool	⇧T	Shift+T
Vertical Type Tool	⇧T	Shift+T
Vertical Area Type Tool	⇧T	Shift+T
Vertical Type on a Path Tool	⇧T	Shift+T
Touch Type Tool	⇧T	⇧T
Paintbrush Tool	B	B
Blob Brush Tool	⇧B	⇧B
Pencil Tool	N	N
Smooth Tool	⇧N	Shift+N
Path Eraser Tool	⇧N	Shift+N
Join Tool	⇧N	Shift+N
Shaper Tool	⇧N	⇧N
Rotate Tool	R	R
Reflect Tool	O	O
Scale Tool	S	S
Shear Tool	⇧S	Shift+S
Reshape Tool	⇧S	Shift+S
Free Transform Tool	E	E
Puppet Warp Tool	⇧E	Shift+E
Width Tool	⇧W	⇧W
Warp Tool	⇧R	⇧R
Twirl Tool	⇧⇧R	Shift+⇧R
Pucker Tool	⇧⇧R	Shift+⇧R
Bloat Tool	⇧⇧R	Shift+⇧R
Scallop Tool	⇧⇧R	Shift+⇧R
Crystallize Tool	⇧⇧R	Shift+⇧R
Wrinkle Tool	⇧⇧R	Shift+⇧R

Brush, color & pointer

ACTION	MACOS	WINDOWS / LINUX
Selection (V) / Direct Selection (A)	V / A	V / A
Pen Tool / Curvature Tool	P / ⇧P	P / ⇧P
Anchor Point Tool (convert corner ↔ smooth)	⇧C	⇧C
Artboard Tool (add, resize, switch artboards)	⇧O	⇧O
Shape Builder Tool (merge overlapping paths)	⇧M	⇧M
Rectangle / Type / Paintbrush / Pencil	M / T / B / N	M / T / B / N
Toggle active swatch / Swap Fill & Stroke / Default swatches	X / ⇧X / D	X / ⇧X / D
Toggle Outline Mode (wireframe Bézier preview)	⌘+Y	Ctrl+Y
Make / Release Compound Path (evenodd cutouts)	⌘+8 / ⌥⇧⌘+8	Ctrl+8 / ⌥⇧Ctrl+8
Join endpoints of open vector paths	⌘+J	Ctrl+J
Fit active artboard / Fit all artboards in window	⌘+0 / ⌥⌘+0	Ctrl+0 / ⌥Ctrl+0
Make / Release Clipping Mask	⌘+7 / ⌥⌘+7	Ctrl+7 / ⌥Ctrl+7
Stroke width / Brush size	[ ]	[ ]
Brush hardness	Shift [ ]	Shift [ ]
Opacity 10% …	1 … 0	1 … 0

ACTION	MACOS	WINDOWS / LINUX
Shape Builder Tool	⇧M	⇧M
Eraser Tool	⇧E	⇧E
Scissors Tool	C	C
Knife Tool	⇧C	Shift+C
Mesh Tool	U	U
Gradient Tool	G	G
Eyedropper Tool	I	I
Measure Tool	⇧I	Shift+I
Blend Tool	W	W
Image Trace Tool	⇧I	⇧I
Live Paint Bucket	K	K
Live Paint Selection Tool	⇧L	⇧L
Symbol Sprayer Tool	⇧S	⇧S
Symbol Shifter Tool	⇧⇧S	Shift+⇧S
Symbol Scruncher Tool	⇧⇧S	Shift+⇧S
Symbol Sizer Tool	⇧⇧S	Shift+⇧S
Symbol Spinner Tool	⇧⇧S	Shift+⇧S
Symbol Stainer Tool	⇧⇧S	Shift+⇧S
Symbol Screener Tool	⇧⇧S	Shift+⇧S
Symbol Styler Tool	⇧⇧S	Shift+⇧S
Column Graph Tool	J	J
Stacked Column Graph Tool	⇧J	Shift+J
Bar Graph Tool	⇧J	Shift+J
Stacked Bar Graph Tool	⇧J	Shift+J
Line Graph Tool	⇧J	Shift+J
Area Graph Tool	⇧J	Shift+J
Scatter Graph Tool	⇧J	Shift+J
Pie Graph Tool	⇧J	Shift+J
Radar Graph Tool	⇧J	Shift+J
Slice Tool	⇧K	⇧K
Slice Select Tool	⇧⇧K	Shift+⇧K
Artboard Tool	⇧O	⇧O
Packaging Dieline Tool	⇧D	⇧D
Hand Tool	H	H
Print Tiling Tool	⇧H	Shift+H
Zoom Tool	Z	Z
Perspective Grid Tool	⇧⇧P	Shift+⇧P
Perspective Selection Tool	⇧⇧V	Shift+⇧V
Rectangular Marquee	⇧M	Shift+M
Elliptical Marquee	⇧M	Shift+M
Polygonal Lasso	⇧L	Shift+L
Crop Tool	⇧C	Shift+C
Clone Stamp	⇧S	Shift+S
Spot Healing Brush	⇧J	Shift+J
Smudge Tool	⇧R	Shift+R
Dodge Tool	⇧O	Shift+O
Burn Tool	⇧O	Shift+O
Sponge Tool	⇧O	Shift+O
Blur Tool	⇧R	Shift+R
Sharpen Tool	⇧R	Shift+R
Single Row Marquee	⇧M	Shift+M
Single Column Marquee	⇧M	Shift+M
Quick Selection	⇧W	Shift+W
Magic Eraser	⇧E	Shift+E

ACTION	MACOS	WINDOWS / LINUX
100% (selected objects, or the painting tool); two quick digits = exact (5 5 → 55%)		
Pan view (any tool)	Space + drag	Space + drag
Zoom at cursor	Pinch / ⌘ + scroll	Ctrl + wheel
Constrain: square, 45°, straight line	Shift (drag)	Shift (drag)
Commit / cancel path, transform, artboard	Enter / Esc	Enter / Esc
Remove anchor point or last segment	⌫ (pen / direct-select)	⌫ (pen / direct-select)
Select multiple shapes / artboards	⌘-click / Shift-click	Ctrl-click / Shift-click
Nudge selected object (Shift = 10px)	Arrows	Arrows
Fit on screen	Double-click (hand)	Double-click (hand)

ACTION	MACOS	WINDOWS / LINUX
Background Eraser	`⇧E`	`Shift+E`
Color Replacement	`⇧B`	`Shift+B`
Red Eye Tool	`⇧J`	`Shift+J`
History Brush	`⇧Y`	`Shift+Y`
Healing Brush	`⇧J`	`Shift+J`
Color Sampler	`⇧I`	`Shift+I`

Regenerate with **npm run docs:shortcuts** · keys come from src/core/commands.ts and src/ui/ToolRail.tsx